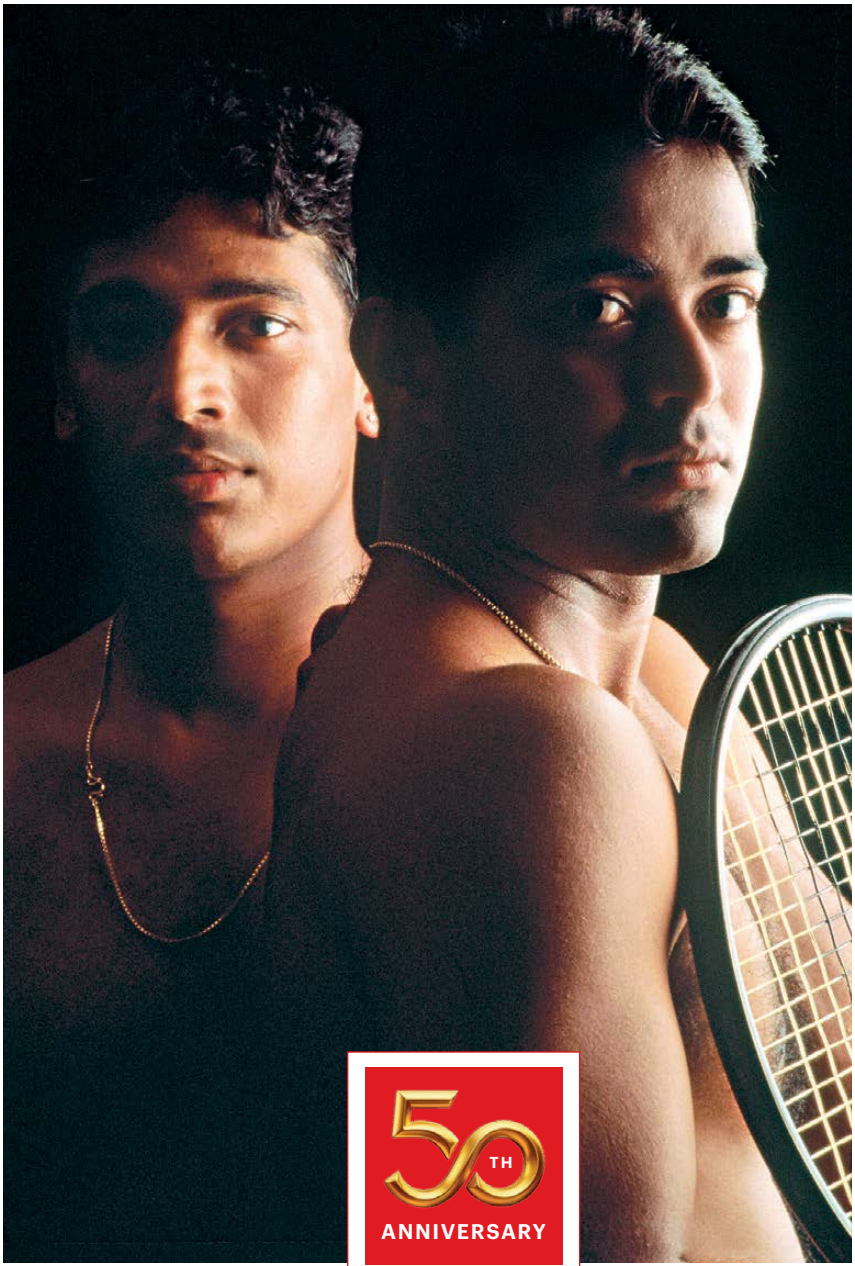


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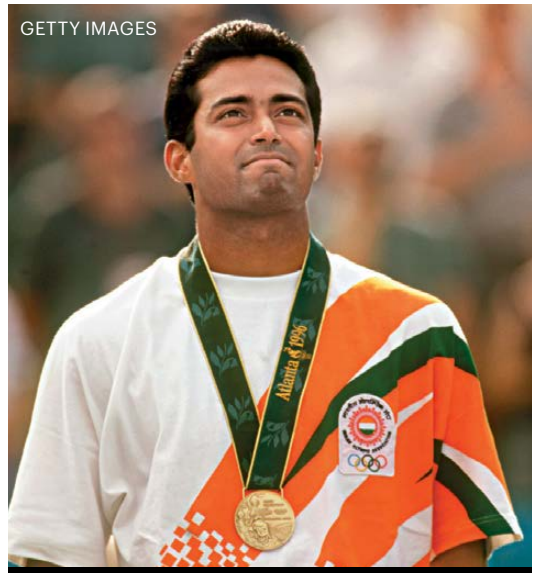
50TH ANNIVERSARY

SPORTS
1995-2005

THE ONE AND THE MANY

India began clocking international wins in individual sports like never before: shooters, weight-lifters and tennis players led the charge

GETTY IMAGES



THE NETWORK Tennis superstars Leander Paes and Mahesh Bhupathi; (above) Paes sporting a bronze at the 1996 Olympics

Having a Ball ▶
Oct. 11, 1999

"...for six days, India has been swooning over the visiting Leander Paes and Mahesh Bhupathi. Make that some of India. One afternoon, as chaos invades the street, a passerby asks another, "What's happening?" Comes the reply, *"Arre, yeh toh woh* table tennis *wale hain*." **"**



Even though his feted match with Russian grandmaster Garry Kasparov in 1995 atop New York's World Trade Center was a loss, Lightning Kid Vishwanathan Anand more than proved his mettle 11 years later when he became only the fourth player in history to cross the 2800 Elo mark. If 1995-2005 was the decade of Sourav Ganguly's elite ensemble taking India up a grade or two as a team